

Sacrifices need concrete compensation

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

A sacrifice gives material for something else: mate, attack, activity, structure, or a later recovery. Separate forcing sacrifices from speculative ones. The more material you give, the more carefully you should test the opponent's defensive resources.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Giving a bishop to open a king's pawn shelter may be sound if your queen and rook can join immediately. If your attacking pieces are still undeveloped, the open file may help the defender more than you.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you calculate before a king attack sacrifice?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Acceptance, refusal, queen exchanges, and counterchecks. Count attackers that can actually arrive, not pieces you hope will become active several moves later.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Demand a mechanism for compensation, not just an attacking mood.